

\$10,000. Since Tatum was starting from scratch, she had a lot to buy. This high credit limit came in handy as she purchased a bedroom set, desk, kitchen utensils, and a living room sofa. She now had an extra expense line in her budget reserved for “furniture payments.”

Once the apartment was under control, Tatum thought she could finally start saving. But she had not counted on her roommate Jenny causing the next delay. It turned out that Jenny had bulimia. This illness resulted in her eating large quantities of food that she would purge shortly afterwards.

In fact, before Tatum noticed Jenny’s illness, she had always wondered how the food she bought at the supermarket disappeared so quickly. After discovering Jenny’s bulimia, she found herself frequenting the supermarket daily to replace the food Jenny had consumed. This was becoming rather expensive in addition to straining their relationship.

Even though Jenny ate most of Tatum’s food, Jenny’s food expenditures still exceeded the amount she allotted for rent. When she did not have enough rent money, she would just avoid paying Tatum. This presented a problem for Tatum since she did not make enough money to cover both of their rent portions. In desperation, she called Jenny’s parents and told them what was going on. Once Jenny found out that her parents knew about her eating disorder, she was furious with Tatum and moved out.

Although Tatum felt relieved that she no longer had to deal with Jenny’s problem, she realized that she now had a new one to take its place. How was she supposed to afford her apartment on her own? She solved her immediate problem by relying on her credit cards to pay the rent until she found a new roommate. By the time she found one, she had accumulated a substantial debt. Every dollar went to pay down the debt, which left none to be saved.

